- To be run and developed cross-platform
- To have a modular architecture for easier maintenance
- To be developed completely as open-source software
- To adhere to web standards
- To be applicable to current trends in web development, such as client-side applications and deployment to cloud environments

To achieve all these goals, Microsoft needed a platform that could provide underlying libraries for creating basic objects such as lists and dictionaries, and for performing tasks such as simple file operations. Up to this point, ASP.NET development had always been focused—and dependent—on the Windows-only .NET Framework. For ASP.NET Core, Microsoft created a lightweight platform that runs on Windows, Linux, and macOS called .NET Core (subsequently .NET), as shown in figure 2.2.